



VERIFICATION METHODOLOGY

The Evidence Standard for ESG and Impact Claims

Framework-Agnostic | Globally Credible | Audit-Ready

Version 1.1

April 2026

1. Purpose and Scope

Purpose

The Synerxus Verification Methodology defines the process for converting operational activity into structured, traceable evidence that supports ESG reporting, impact measurement, third-party review, and assurance preparation across multiple reporting frameworks and jurisdictions.

Scope

This methodology covers:

Activity verification across corporate volunteering, NGO programs, and community initiatives.

Outcome confirmation by independent third parties including NGOs, employers, and beneficiaries.

Framework-agnostic evidence collection that maps to WEF SCM, GRI, SASB, TCFD, ESRS (CSRD), and UN SDGs.

Audit-ready documentation for management reporting and assurance preparation in any jurisdiction.

Exclusions

This methodology does not:

Issue formal assurance opinions. Independent auditor review per ISAE 3000 remains required for limited or reasonable assurance.

Establish causal attribution or calculate social return on investment (SROI).

Provide financial valuation of outcomes.

POSITIONING

Synerxus creates audit-ready verification evidence for ESG and impact claims. We use WEF Stakeholder Capitalism Metrics as our primary framework backbone, with mappings to regional and sector-specific standards including ESRS, SASB, GRI, and TCFD.

2. Framework Architecture

Synerxus uses a framework-agnostic architecture that enables evidence to satisfy multiple reporting requirements without recollection or reformatting.

Primary Framework: WEF Stakeholder Capitalism Metrics

The World Economic Forum Stakeholder Capitalism Metrics (WEF SCM) serves as the primary framework backbone. WEF SCM was explicitly designed to harmonize major global frameworks and is endorsed by GRI, SASB, CDP, and the EU Commission.

WHY WEF SCM

WEF SCM is the only framework simultaneously aligned with GRI, SASB, TCFD, and ESRS. It provides a single evidence structure that satisfies US, EU, and international reporting requirements.

WEF SCM Four Pillars

All verified outcomes map to one of four WEF SCM pillars:

Pillar	Focus Areas	Framework Crosswalks
Governance	ESG integration, risk oversight, stakeholder engagement	GRI 102, SASB CG, ESRS G1
Planet	GHG emissions, water, waste, land use, biodiversity	TCFD, GRI 300 series, ESRS E1-E5
People	DEI, health & safety, training, living wage, community impact	GRI 400 series, SASB, ESRS S1-S4
Prosperity	Employment, innovation, economic value, taxes paid	GRI 200 series, SASB, ESRS G1

Regional Framework Mappings

Each verified outcome automatically maps to applicable regional and sector standards:

Region / Context	Framework	Synerxus Mapping
European Union	ESRS (CSRD)	S1-S4 social metrics, E1-E5 environmental metrics
United States	SASB	Sector-specific materiality indicators
United States	SEC Climate	Scope 1, 2, 3 emissions where applicable
Global	GRI Standards	GRI 413 (Communities), GRI 403 (Health & Safety)
Global	TCFD	Climate-related metrics and governance
Global	UN SDGs	Primary and secondary goal alignment

ONE EVIDENCE OBJECT, MULTIPLE FRAMEWORKS

Users collect evidence once. Synerxus maps that evidence to all applicable frameworks automatically. Reports can be filtered by framework based on the audience.

3. Verification Principles

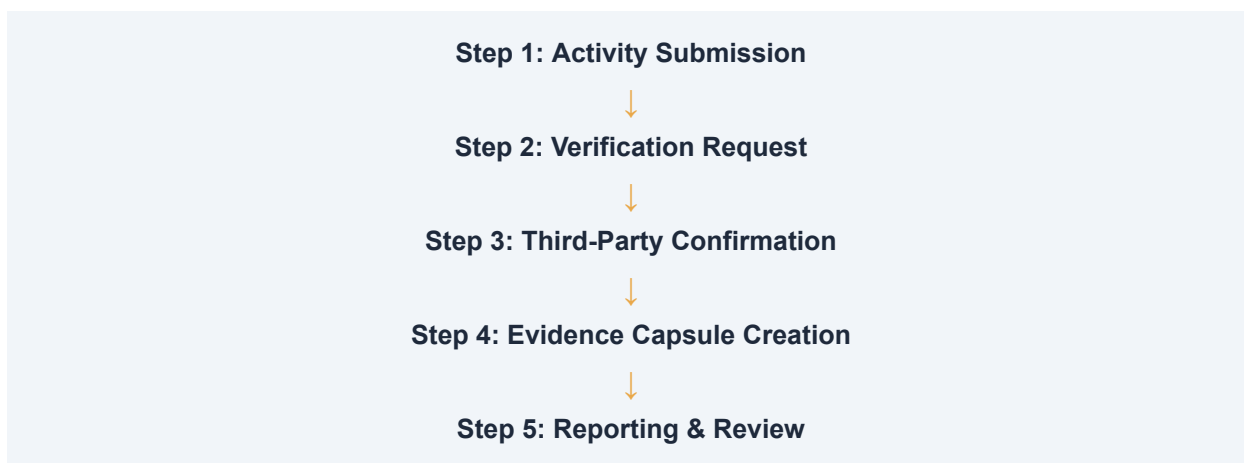
Synerxus verification is built on five core principles:

Principle	Definition
Traceability	Every claim links to source evidence with a verifiable chain of custody.
Independence	Third-party confirmation by parties external to the claim submitter.
Timeliness	Evidence captured within defined operational windows (maximum 72 hours).
Completeness	All required metadata for audit review is captured at verification.
Reproducibility	Standardized process applied consistently across users and contexts.

These principles align with ISAE 3000 evidence requirements for relevance, reliability, and source documentation, regardless of which regional framework applies.

4. Verification Workflow

The verification process follows five sequential steps:



Step 1: Activity Submission

Who: Program managers, CSR teams, NGO staff, or volunteers.

Required fields:

Field	Description	Required
Outcome description	What was accomplished	Yes
Beneficiary count	Number of individuals or entities served	Yes
WEF Pillar	Governance, Planet, People, or Prosperity	Yes
Framework tags	SDG, ESRS, GRI, SASB as applicable	Auto-mapped
Date / time completed	When the activity occurred	Yes
Location	Where the activity occurred	Optional

Validation includes plausibility checks and duplicate detection.

Step 2: Verification Request

Trigger: Sent automatically following activity submission.

Channels: SMS, app notification, or email based on verifier preference.

Content: One-line outcome summary with confirm or reject option.

Step 3: Third-Party Confirmation

Who: NGO staff, employers, beneficiaries, or program leads — parties independent of the submitter.

Process: Single-tap confirmation or rejection with optional comment.

Time: Verification can be completed within 15 seconds. Maximum verification window is 72 hours.

Identity capture: Phone number, device ID, and role verification.

INDEPENDENCE REQUIREMENT

The verifier must be independent of the claim submitter. Self-verification is not permitted. This separation is foundational to evidence reliability across all frameworks.

Step 4: Evidence Capsule Creation

Upon confirmation, the system generates a machine-readable evidence object containing:

Claim details (outcome, beneficiary count, WEF pillar)

Multi-framework tags (SDG, ESRS, GRI, SASB, TCFD as applicable)

Verification metadata (timestamp, verifier identity, device, geolocation)

Integrity data (content hash, verification signature)

Step 5: Reporting & Review

Formats: PDF report, API export, dashboard view.

Framework filtering: Reports can be filtered by framework (WEF, ESRS, GRI, SASB, SDG) based on audience.

Access: No-login PDF links for external sharing; role-based dashboard for internal review.

5. Evidence Object Specification

Each verified outcome produces a structured evidence object with multi-framework tagging. The core structure is:

Evidence Object Structure

```
{
  "claimId": "syn-20260407-001",
  "outcome": "Financial literacy workshop for 47 smallholder farmers",
  "beneficiaryCount": 47,
  "frameworks": {
    "wef": {
      "pillar": "People",
      "metric": "Community & Social Vitality"
    },
    "sdg": {
      "primary": "SDG 2 Zero Hunger",
      "secondary": "SDG 8 Decent Work"
    },
    "esrs": "S3.4 Affected Communities",
    "gri": "GRI 413-1 Local Communities",
    "sasb": null
  },
  "verification": {
    "confirmedAt": "2026-04-07T14:23:12Z",
    "confirmedBy": {
      "verifierId": "ngo-mariasantos-001",
      "role": "Program Director",
      "organization": "Lusaka Youth Initiative",
      "contact": "+260971234567"
    },
    "device": {
      "deviceId": "hash:sha256-abc123...",
      "geo": "-15.3875, 28.3228"
    },
    "integrity": {
      "hash": "sha256:def456...",
      "signature": "sms:verified"
    }
  },
  "status": "verified"
}
```

Field Requirements

Field	Status	Description
claimId	Required	Unique identifier for the claim
outcome	Required	Description of what was accomplished
beneficiaryCount	Required	Number served
frameworks.wef	Required	WEF SCM pillar and metric
frameworks.sdg	Required	Primary SDG alignment
frameworks.esrs	Auto-mapped	ESRS topic (if EU-relevant)
frameworks.gri	Auto-mapped	GRI standard reference
frameworks.sasb	Auto-mapped	SASB indicator (if sector-relevant)
verification.confirmedAt	Required	ISO 8601 timestamp
verification.confirmedBy	Required	Verifier identity object
verification.device	Required	Device and location metadata
verification.integrity.hash	Required	Content hash for tamper detection

6. Framework Alignment Matrix

The following matrix demonstrates how Synerxus evidence maps across major reporting frameworks. This crosswalk enables a single evidence collection to satisfy multiple reporting requirements.

WEF SCM to Regional Framework Mapping

WEF Pillar / Metric	GRI	SASB	TCFD	ESRS (CSRD)
Governance — Risk oversight	GRI 2-12, 2-13	CG-330a.1	Governance (a)-(c)	ESRS G1
Planet — GHG Emissions	GRI 305-1,2,3	Sector-specific	Metrics (a)-(c)	ESRS E1-5, E1-6
Planet — Water consumption	GRI 303-5	Sector-specific	—	ESRS E3
People — Health & Safety	GRI 403	Sector-specific	—	ESRS S1-14
People — Community impact	GRI 413-1	Sector-specific	—	ESRS S3-4
Prosperity — Employment	GRI 401	Sector-specific	—	ESRS S1-6
Prosperity — Economic value	GRI 201-1	Sector-specific	—	ESRS G1

Audience-Specific Report Views

Reports can be filtered by framework based on the intended audience:

Audience	Primary Framework View	Secondary References
EU Corporate (CSRD-obligated)	ESRS topics (S1-S4, E1-E5)	WEF pillar, GRI crosswalk
US Corporate (SEC-obligated)	SASB materiality indicators	WEF pillar, TCFD alignment
Global NGO / Foundation	UN SDGs with WEF pillar	GRI 413 reference
Impact Investor	WEF SCM with SDG overlay	All framework crosswalks
Auditor / Assurance Provider	Full crosswalk matrix	ISAE 3000 evidence mapping

GLOBAL CREDIBILITY

WEF SCM provides crosswalk documentation mapping every metric to GRI, SASB, TCFD, and ESRS. This means one audit procedure can satisfy multiple framework requirements across jurisdictions.

7. Integrity and Review Controls

Identity Controls

Phone number validation confirms verifier identity.

Role-based permissions restrict access by user type.

Device fingerprinting provides additional identity assurance.

Time Controls

Maximum verification window of 72 hours from activity submission.

Timestamp validation ensures chronological consistency.

Late verifications are flagged for review.

Data Controls

Duplicate detection based on claim ID and outcome matching.

Plausibility checks compare beneficiary counts against historical patterns.

Geolocation reasonableness validates verifier proximity to activity location.

Exception Handling

Condition	Action
Rejected claim	Routed to manual review queue
Missing metadata	Flagged for completion before export
Fraud signals detected	Held for investigation
Late verification	Accepted with late flag in evidence object
Duplicate submission	Blocked with notification to submitter

8. Assurance Alignment

The Synerxus Verification Methodology produces evidence designed to support assurance procedures under ISAE 3000 (Revised), regardless of which regional framework applies.

Evidence Characteristics

ISAE 3000 Requirement	Synerxus Support
Relevant evidence	Claims tagged to specific framework metrics (WEF, GRI, ESRS, SASB)
Reliable evidence	Third-party confirmation with identity verification
Source documentation	Complete audit trail with verifier, timestamp, device, location
Completeness	All required metadata captured at point of verification
Tamper evidence	Content hashing provides integrity assurance

Assurance Boundaries

Synerxus creates evidence that supports assurance. We do not provide assurance opinions.

Assurance Type	Synerxus Role	Auditor Role
Limited Assurance	Provide evidence trails and crosswalks	Issue opinion per ISAE 3000
Reasonable Assurance	Provide evidence trails and crosswalks	Issue opinion per ISAE 3000
Management Verification	Complete verification with audit trail	Review optional

ASSURANCE RELATIONSHIP

Synerxus creates the evidence. Independent auditors provide the assurance. For CSRD, SEC, or other regulatory assurance requirements, auditor review per ISAE 3000 remains required.

9. Governance

Roles

Role	Responsibility
Submitter	Records activity and outcome claims
Verifier	Confirms or rejects outcomes (independent third party)
Reviewer	Handles exceptions and disputed claims
Admin	Manages users, permissions, and reporting

Data Lifecycle

Phase	Details
Collection	Real-time capture at submission and verification
Retention	Minimum 7 years for audit compliance
Export	PDF, JSON, and CSV formats; filterable by framework
Deletion	GDPR-compliant deletion upon request with audit log retention

Dispute Resolution

30-day review window for disputed claims.

Full evidence audit log available for review.

Escalation path to program administrator for unresolved disputes.

10. Sample Verified Record

The following illustrates a completed verification record with multi-framework tagging:

VERIFIED OUTCOME

Claim: Financial literacy workshop served 47 smallholder farmers

Status: **Verified**

Verifier: Maria Santos, Program Director, Lusaka Youth Initiative

Verified: 2026-04-07 14:23 UTC

Location: Lusaka, Zambia

FRAMEWORK ALIGNMENT

WEF: People — Community & Social Vitality

SDG: SDG 2 Zero Hunger, SDG 8 Decent Work

GRI: GRI 413-1 Local Communities

ESRS: S3.4 Affected Communities

Evidence Hash: sha256:def456...

11. Limitations and Boundaries

The Synerxus Verification Methodology operates within defined boundaries:

What This Methodology Provides

Structured evidence collection with multi-framework tagging.

Third-party confirmation workflows with identity verification.

Audit-ready documentation with chain of custody.

Framework crosswalks for WEF, GRI, SASB, TCFD, ESRS, and SDGs.

Support for assurance preparation across jurisdictions.

What This Methodology Does Not Provide

Formal assurance opinions. Independent auditor review per ISAE 3000 remains required for limited or reasonable assurance under any regulatory framework.

Causal attribution or proof of causality between activities and outcomes.

Financial valuation or SROI calculations.

Guarantee of outcome validity — verification quality depends on partner participation.

Regulatory compliance certification — organizations remain responsible for their own compliance.

BOUNDARY STATEMENT

Synerxus creates audit-ready verification evidence using WEF Stakeholder Capitalism Metrics as the primary framework backbone, with mappings to GRI, SASB, TCFD, ESRS, and UN SDGs. We support assurance preparation and reduce evidence-gathering friction. We do not replace independent assurance providers or guarantee regulatory compliance.

Organizations using Synerxus evidence for CSRD, SEC, or other regulatory reporting should engage independent assurance providers for formal assurance opinions.

12. Version History

Version	Date	Changes
1.0	April 2026	Initial release (ESRS-primary)
1.1	April 2026	Updated to WEF SCM-primary with multi-framework mapping architecture

— END OF DOCUMENT —

Synerxus | Impacts. Verified!

Framework-Agnostic | Globally Credible | Audit-Ready

synerxus.com